

Figure 3: Home 2

keep your expenses within control. Egonomize provides a complete solution with a double-entry system. It supports the following types of accounts: current, savings, credit card, cash, securities and liabilities.

The cash account is just like your wallet—it shows how much cash you have in hand.

You can create categories of incomes and expenditures, as needed. Once expenditure has occurred, you can still record refunds that have been made by right-clicking the expense and selecting *Refund* from the drop down menu.

There is a feature that allows you to get the summary of all transactions in pictorial or tabular form (Figure 2). Egonomize also shows the remaining budget in each category, so that you can spend wisely. When the need arises, you can also export your transaction details as QIF, CSV and HTML files.

One small feature that could have been included in Egonomize is 'auto-save'. Quite often, I enter all my transactions, and forget to save them. Maybe the team will include that feature in the coming versions.

Egonomize can be installed from the Ubuntu Software Centre or by running `sudo apt-get install egonomize`.

Grisbi

Grisbi is another PFM, released under the GPL licence, and runs on Linux and Windows. It can handle multiple accounts, but does not use the double-entry system. It allows users to enter the details of the bank, the phone number of the bank, etc; so it can be used even to store such details. It has a vast set of categories defined by default.

The initial set-up asks for details like the name of the account holder, the type of account, the bank's name, the contact details of the bank, etc. Grisbi can handle multiple currencies. It creates budgetary lines, provides statistics of various accounts, records your expenses and income, and does scheduled transactions; you can import QIV files and even export QIF and CSV files.

A feature called the Credit Simulator can simulate loan interest amounts that will have to be paid after a certain period of time. Grisbi is a bit complicated compared to Egonomize, but if you take the time to learn how to use it, it can make your life easy.

Grisbi is also available in the Ubuntu Software Centre, or you can run `sudo apt-get install grisbi` in a terminal.

Skrrooge

Skrrooge is a PFM for KDE 4, intended to be used by those who want to keep an eye on their money. It can keep track of your income and expenses across several accounts, in several currencies. It has all

the features you would expect from such a tool, such as categories, scheduled operations, graphical reporting, stocks management, etc. It also has some less common features, like fast operation edition, search as you type, refund trackers, customisable attributes, etc. The best part of the Skrooge home page is that it provides a summary of all your accounts and displays a report along with some advice (Figure 6).

Skrrooge can create current, investments, credit card, assets, loan, wallet, and other accounts. Like Grisbi, Skrooge also has an option to enter your bank account number and contact details—and you can even have your bank logo associated with your accounts. Recording transactions is also quite similar to Egonomize. You just enter the amount,

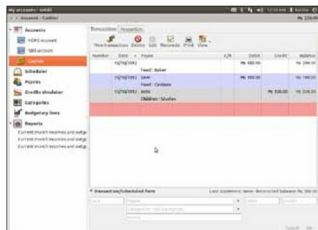


Figure 4: Transactions

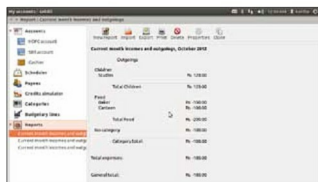


Figure 5: Reports